



Individual Instructor Report Fall 2025 Version A for STA 235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (05795) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Fall 2025**

Courses Audience: **50**
Responses Received: **50**
Response Ratio: **100 %**

Subject Details

merged_subject_id

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Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Monday, January 26, 2026**

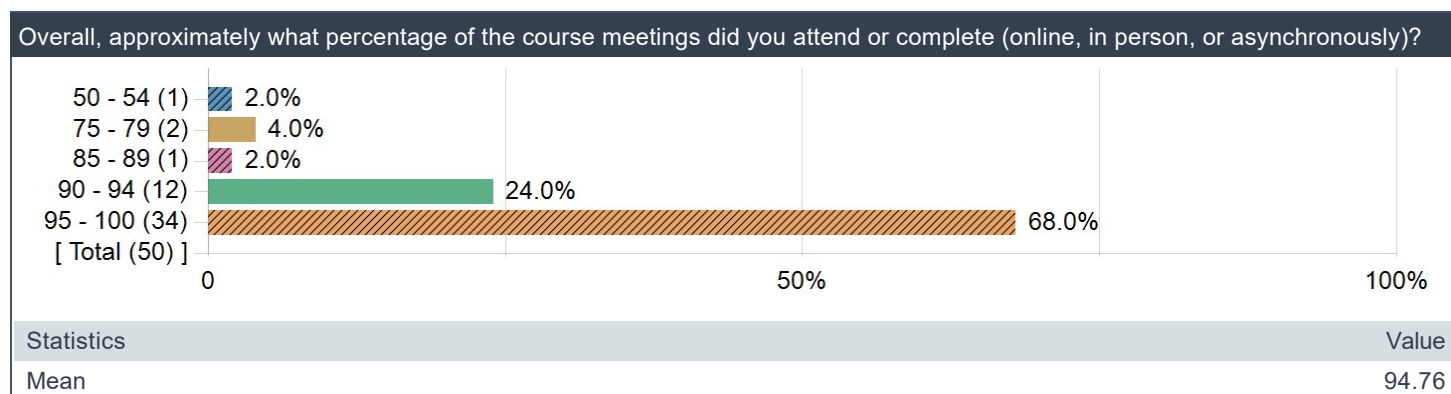
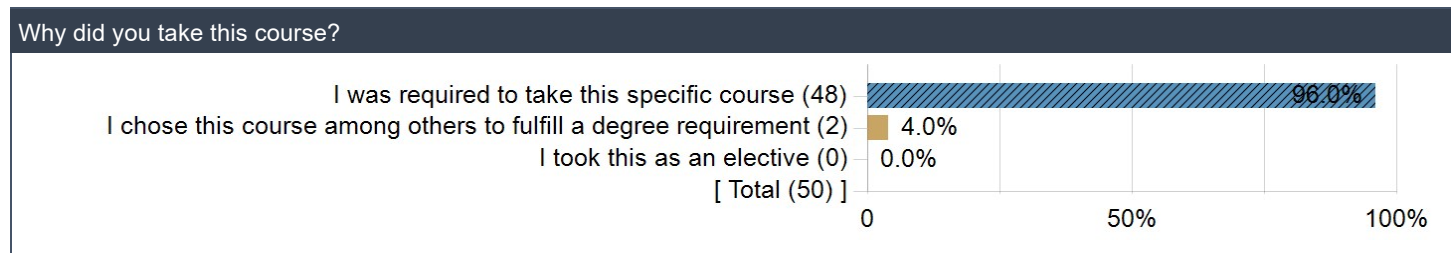
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	52.0%	46.0%	2.0%	0.0%	0.0%	50	4.50
The course was well organized.	50.0%	32.0%	16.0%	2.0%	0.0%	50	4.30
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	58.0%	38.0%	4.0%	0.0%	0.0%	50	4.54
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	72.0%	26.0%	2.0%	0.0%	0.0%	50	4.70
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	56.0%	38.0%	6.0%	0.0%	0.0%	50	4.50
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	56.0%	28.0%	10.0%	6.0%	0.0%	50	4.34
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	66.0%	30.0%	4.0%	0.0%	0.0%	50	4.62

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	68.0%	26.0%	6.0%	0.0%	0.0%	50	4.62
Overall, this course was	36.0%	40.0%	24.0%	0.0%	0.0%	50	4.12

Other Course Questions



Comment Questions

Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

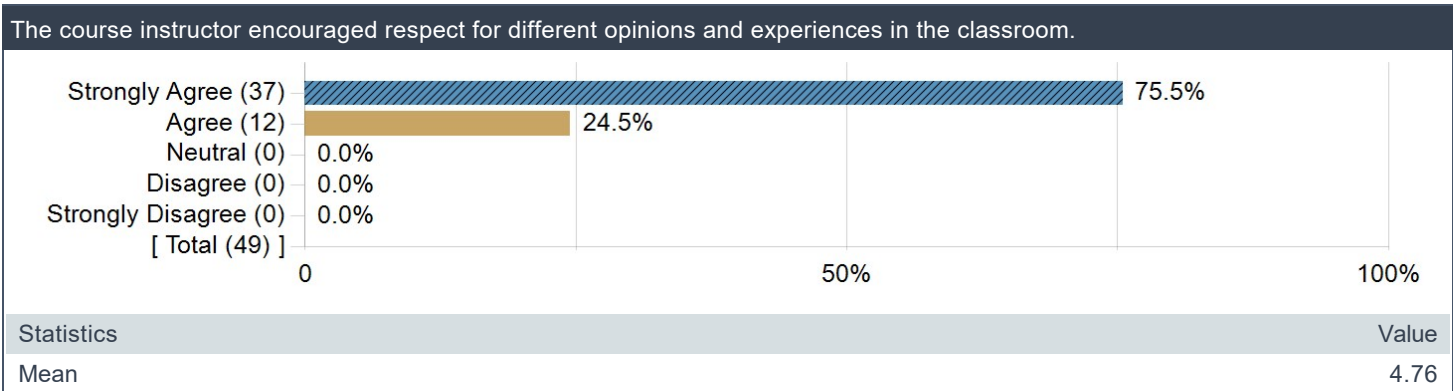
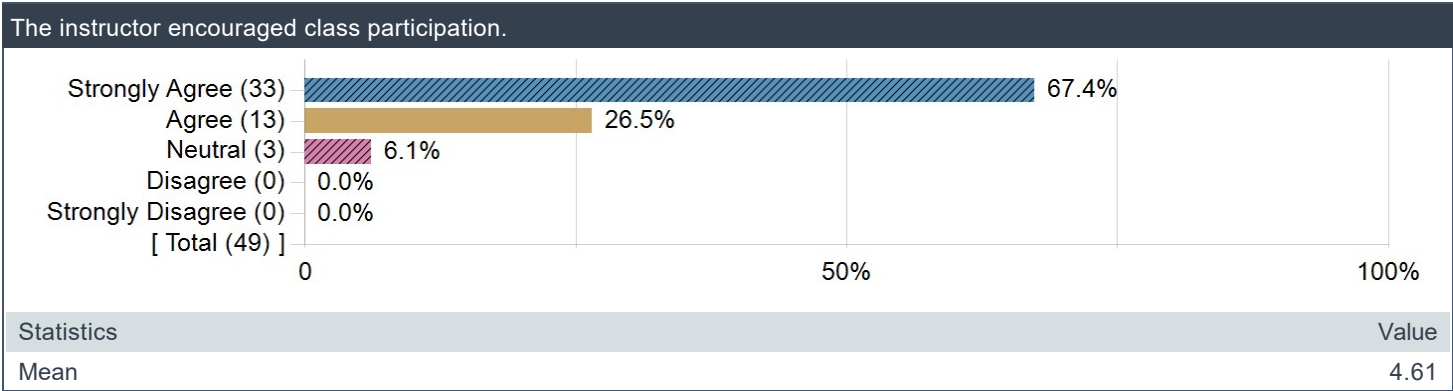
Comment
The homeworks and collaborative quizzes
Homeworks were helpful for learning and in-class walkthrough examples
Daily quizzes and homework assignments
SI review sessions were helpful.
TA review sessions each week
I think that having numerous assignments reinforced the concepts in my mind and helped me understand them better.
Professor Bolfarine was great at teaching the underlying concepts and the practice quizzes were good too.
There was a lot of content to study for tests.
The in-class quizzes made sure that I stayed on track with the content in the class. They helped me make sure I met deadlines in the course and forced me to stay up-to-date.
The best part of the course was how slow and steady the professor went when explaining topics, as it gave a better understanding of the harder concepts. I also loved the end-of-class quizzes.
Great Professor
Practice problems on R
The in class quizzes that were collaborative
Learning the code
The Homeworks and the Practice Exams
The lecture slides.
The checkpoint quizzes, surprisingly, always kept me updated with the content and had the most positive impact in my learning.
I think Professor Bolfarine is an amazing professor. He really cares about his students. He made this subject a lot more digestible.
The aspects of the course that wer most effective in my learning were the homeworks and office hours.
The extra resources like TA video recordings
professor was helpful and informative
The professor was engaging towards the class, always asking questions and ensuring our understanding. The pre class quizzes also help my understanding as I was able to work with peers in the class to answer relevant question.
The in-class lectures were probably the most helpful for my understanding of the content.
The professor was very engaging with the class.
Homeworks
The proffesor was great, knowledgeable, caring, and funny.
He went through many examples with Rstudio in class which was helpful for the homeworks and tests.
The homework assignments were a great opportunity to practice the content of the class. In addition to this the lecture slides were clear, concise, and contained the information necessary for me to succeed.
The class was really well structured. The professor had a table with links to the material for each week, and the TA also made material every week.
This professor was the most chill and understanding professor ever. People should learn from him.
The professor did a phenomenal job at breaking down concepts and elaborating on difficult topics to the best of his ability.
Providing numerous study materials.
The instructor walked us through R code, examples, slideshows, and notes during class. He didn't go too quickly and would check to make sure we understood. He was very accomodating and good at answering questions.
Practice exams helped prep me for the exam.
The quizzes before and after class were very helpful

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comment
lack of examples in class, rather just watching and copying down work.
The coding and sometimes boring and long lessons, I think there is enough content to make it a 3 credit hour course.
The in-class quizzes felt easier than the exams, so maybe make them a little more code-involved
Exams were hard, and lockdown browser was slow/laggy
The content itself was very hard to grasp. The course being once a week made it difficult to memorize content for the next class. I think in addition to the review sessions more in depth review slides would be helpful.
I found it difficult to see the translation from classes to the homeworks. I think tying the in class demos more to the homeworks would be more beneficial so similar types of problems in class as the homeworks and just switching the numbers or something similar. I also think there was too much content crammed into each class (I know we were told this was the first year they were covering more content but I found that hindered my ability to comprehend.)
It was difficult to deal with the pacing of the course and grasping all the concepts in short time spans. I think the pacing can be changed to incorporate some of the more difficult concepts earlier on. I also think that we should change from R to another language since R is not commonly used in the real work force.
applying some of the quizzes to the tests and figuring out what we actually needed to know.
The content was especially difficult, way more difficult then STA 301
I found the homeworks challenging, as sometimes the questions' required code wasn't clearly taught to us. Thus, although I knew the concept, it was hard to figure out how to solve the problems.
The hardest part of the class was stats in R Studio itself, but we were already warned that the content is hard. However, the professor made it easy to understand from how he taught. One thing that could help the future students would be an in-person review session or practice every week after class.
Some topics were a little hard
Some of the R coding on the hw was not used in class or assessed in quizzes or exams. I do not see a reason to include the difficult programming if it is not really a part of the course. This was especially true with decision trees. I think overall the hws could have reflected the class and exams better.
Exam open ended questions. providing more practice for that in class
Understanding the code
Quizzes
Maybe reduce content a bit.
The speed of the course was extremely hard to keep up with. Lectures felt rushed and the level of difficulty from the homework did not correspond to the depth that we covered in lectures. Ended up being more time consuming than I would expect from a 2-hour credit course.
I think the only thing that made completing quizzes and exams was the lockdown browser, because it would glitch and we would have to close it and then open it again.
The aspect of the course I found most challenging was using lockdown browser/webR. It was challenging to go in between my exam tab and my webR tab. One thing that could be done to help future students is requiring students to share their screen instead.
Having quizzes every week was extremely challenging. I also do not like how the class is only once a week but for 2 hours. It made learning more challenging.
material
The most challenging part of the class was the material itself. Sometimes concepts were a little hard to grasp but I suspect that's the nature of the class as its just not easy to teach.
The quizzes at the beginning of every class were very challenging, mainly just because of the content difficulty. One thing to help in the future is to make them all group quizzes instead of only select one.
The homeworks were the most challenging part of the course.
Exams were very difficult
The content itself. I Not much to be done other than personally putting in the work.
The course material was extremely difficult for me. The professor had kind of an accent which honestly makes it hard to understand in class at times. I suggest he holds more office hours or review sessions for each exam specifically.
I found R studio programming to be the most challenging aspect of this course. Perhaps some more general resources/guides on how to code the specific functions needed to execute certain important operations.
The content itself is difficult to understand sometimes. I would like to be able to revisit the homework when studying.
The content was challenging in many aspects.
The most challenging aspect of the course was trying to understand how to understand the coding information after putting it into r-

Comment
studio. It was difficult because I takes me a good amount of attempts to interpret and process new information and apply it to the questions. For future students, attend office hours and review sessions so you can receive the support you need and don't wait last second as the topics only get harder.
Course work
The in class quizzes were stressful and I think they should be collaborative.
Web R (lockdown version of R studio) was very hard to use. It lagged a lot and stressed me out during timed exams. We only used it for exams, so it was also hard to get used to.
I found the exams to be challenging because they seemed a lot harder than the homework's or quizzes.

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.